

Category	Command	Purpose	Example
Service management	systemctl status osqueryd	Check osquery daemon status	Verify if service is running
	systemctl start osqueryd	Start osquery daemon	Start background monitoring
	systemctl stop osqueryd	Stop daemon	Stop before config change
	systemctl restart osqueryd	Restart service	Apply new config
	systemctl enable osqueryd	Enable at boot	Persistence after reboot
Interactive shell	osqueryi	Launch interactive console	Run live queries
	.tables	List all available tables	Discover data sources
	.schema <table>	View schema of table	.schema processes
	.help	Show help menu	CLI assistance
System information	SELECT * FROM system_info;	Host OS & hardware info	IR baseline
	SELECT * FROM uptime;	System uptime	Detect reboots
	SELECT hostname, cpu_brand FROM system_info;	Host identity	Asset validation
User investigation	SELECT * FROM users;	Local users list	Account audit
	SELECT * FROM logged_in_users;	Active sessions	Live access detection
	SELECT * FROM last;	Login history	Persistence check
Process investigation	SELECT * FROM processes;	Running processes	Malware hunt
	SELECT name,pid,path FROM processes;	Key process details	Suspicious binary check
	SELECT * FROM process_open_files WHERE pid=<PID>;	Files used by process	Data exfil analysis
File integrity / artifacts	SELECT * FROM file WHERE path='/etc/passwd';	Check file metadata	Integrity verification
	SELECT * FROM hash WHERE path='/bin/bash';	File hash	IOC comparison
	SELECT * FROM yara WHERE path='/home';	Scan with YARA	Threat detection
Network investigation	SELECT * FROM listening_ports;	Open ports	Backdoor detection
	SELECT * FROM process_open_sockets;	Process-network mapping	C2 analysis
	SELECT * FROM interface_addresses;	IP addresses	Network inventory
	SELECT * FROM arp_cache;	ARP entries	Lateral movement
Persistence checks	SELECT * FROM crontab;	Cron jobs	Scheduled malware
	SELECT * FROM startup_items;	Startup programs	Persistence vectors
	SELECT * FROM services;	System services	Rogue services
Log & security	SELECT * FROM sudoers;	Sudo access	Privilege audit
	SELECT * FROM groups;	Group memberships	Admin enumeration
Package auditing	SELECT * FROM rpm_packages;	Installed packages	Unauthorized software
	SELECT name,version FROM rpm_packages;	Package versions	Vulnerability mapping
Kernel & hardware	SELECT * FROM kernel_modules;	Loaded modules	Rootkit detection
	SELECT * FROM block_devices;	Disk devices	Rogue storage
Configuration paths	/etc/osquery/osquery.conf	Main config file	Query packs & logging
	/var/log/osquery/	Logs directory	Incident evidence

High-value IR query examples:

Scenario	Query
Suspicious processes	SELECT pid,name,path,cmdline FROM processes WHERE name LIKE '%ssh%';
Unauthorized users	SELECT * FROM users WHERE uid >= 1000;
External connections	SELECT * FROM process_open_sockets WHERE remote_address NOT LIKE '127.%';
Persistence hunt	SELECT * FROM crontab WHERE command NOT LIKE '%system%';
Recently modified binaries	SELECT * FROM file WHERE directory='/usr/bin' ORDER BY mtime DESC LIMIT 20;

1) Host triage

Objective	Query
Identify host details	SELECT hostname, os_version, cpu_brand FROM system_info;
System uptime	SELECT * FROM uptime;
Kernel version	SELECT version FROM kernel_info;

2) User & access investigation

Objective	Query
Local users	SELECT * FROM users;
Active sessions	SELECT * FROM logged_in_users;
Login history	SELECT * FROM last;
Sudo privileges	SELECT * FROM sudoers;
Admin groups	SELECT * FROM groups WHERE groupname='wheel';

3) Process & malware hunting

Objective	Query
Running processes	SELECT pid,name,path,cmdline FROM processes;
Suspicious binaries	SELECT * FROM processes WHERE path NOT LIKE '/usr/%';
Parent-child chain	SELECT pid,parent,name,path FROM processes;
Open files by process	SELECT * FROM process_open_files;

4) Persistence detection

Objective	Query
Cron jobs	SELECT * FROM crontab;
Services	SELECT name,status,path FROM services;
Startup programs	SELECT * FROM startup_items;

5) Network triage

Objective	Query
Listening ports	SELECT * FROM listening_ports;
Active sockets	SELECT * FROM process_open_sockets;
External connections	SELECT pid,remote_address,remote_port FROM process_open_sockets WHERE remote_address NOT LIKE '127.%';

Objective	Query
IP addresses	SELECT * FROM interface_addresses;

6) File integrity & artifacts

Objective	Query
File hash	SELECT * FROM hash WHERE path='/bin/bash';
Modified binaries	SELECT path,mtime FROM file WHERE directory='/usr/bin' ORDER BY mtime DESC LIMIT 20;
YARA scan	SELECT * FROM yara WHERE path='/home';

7) Package & kernel audit

Objective	Query
Installed packages	SELECT * FROM rpm_packages;
Kernel modules	SELECT * FROM kernel_modules;
Block devices	SELECT * FROM block_devices;

Osquery IR Playbook mapped to ATT&CK-style phases

Initial access validation

Goal	Query
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Check new users `SELECT * FROM users WHERE uid >= 1000;`

Suspicious logins `SELECT * FROM last WHERE host NOT LIKE '192.%';`

Execution detection

Goal	Query
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Suspicious commands `SELECT pid,cmdline FROM processes WHERE cmdline LIKE '%wget%';`

Binary from temp dirs `SELECT * FROM processes WHERE path LIKE '/tmp/%';`

Persistence discovery

Goal	Query
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Cron persistence `SELECT * FROM crontab WHERE command NOT LIKE '%system%';`

Rogue service `SELECT * FROM services WHERE status!='running';`

Privilege escalation

Goal	Query
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Sudo abuse `SELECT * FROM sudoers;`

Wheel group users `SELECT * FROM user_groups WHERE groupname='wheel';`

Defense evasion

Goal	Query
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Disabled security tools `SELECT * FROM processes WHERE name LIKE '%audit%';`

Hidden files `SELECT * FROM file WHERE filename LIKE '.*%';`

Credential access

Goal	Query
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SSH keys `SELECT * FROM file WHERE path LIKE '/home/%/.ssh/%';`

Shadow access `SELECT * FROM process_open_files WHERE path='/etc/shadow';`

Discovery

Goal	Query
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Network interfaces `SELECT * FROM interface_details;`

ARP enumeration `SELECT * FROM arp_cache;`

Lateral movement

Goal	Query
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Remote connections	SELECT * FROM process_open_sockets WHERE remote_address!='127.0.0.1';
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SSH processes	SELECT * FROM processes WHERE name='ssh';
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Command & control

Goal	Query
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External IP traffic	SELECT * FROM process_open_sockets WHERE remote_port NOT IN (80,443);
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Exfiltration indicators

Goal	Query
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Large file access	SELECT * FROM process_open_files WHERE size > 100000000;
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